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AIR FORCE SPECIAL OPERATIONS COMMAND

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Flying Operations

WEAPONS AND TACTICS PROGRAM

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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This publication implements the Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 11-2, *Aircrew Operations*, Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 10-7, *Information Operations (IO)*, Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 10-703, *Electromagnetic Warfare Integrated Reprogramming*, Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 10-706, *Electronic Warfare (EW),* DAFMAN 11-260, *Tactics Development Program*, Air Force Manual (AFMAN) 13-116, *Tactical Data Link Planning and Operations*, and DAFMAN 11-415, *Weapons and Tactics Program*. It establishes guidance, responsibilities, and procedures for conducting the AFSOC weapons and tactics program and electronic warfare training. It is applicable to Air Force Special Operations Command (AFSOC), Air National Guard (ANG) and Air Force Reserve Command (AFRC) units. This publication does not apply to the United States Space Force. This instruction applies during peacetime, contingency, and wartime. Ensure that all records created because of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of in accordance with Air Force Records Information Management System Records Disposition Schedule. This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all supplements must be routed to OPR of this publication prior to certification and approval. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication on DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*, and forward to AFSOCA3.A3FW.WeaponsandTactics@us.af.mil for action. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to this publication's OPR. The authorities to waive wing/unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-2, or T-3") number following the compliance statement. See DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and*

Procedures, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority, or alternately, to the publication OPR for non-tiered compliance items. Active-duty units submit requests for deviations from this instruction to AFSOC/A3 unless otherwise noted.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document is substantially revised and must be completely reviewed. This revision establishes the division of responsibilities between HQ AFSOC/A3FW and the 18 Special Operations and Test & Evaluation Squadron Weapons and Tactics Development (18 SOTES/WT). It also complements DAFMAN 11-415, *Weapons and Tactics Programs,* and DAFMAN 11-260, *Tactics Development Program,* while providing clarity to AFSOC specific items, though defers to higher level guidance for any potential conflicts.

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Chapter 1

OVERVIEW

1.1. General. HQ AFSOC is the lead command for developing, documenting, and disseminating tactics for Air Force Special Operation Forces (AFSOF), AFSOC-gained Air National Guard (ANG), and Air Force Reserve Component (AFRC) forces. This publication defines the AFSOC tactics program structure for successful execution. The HQ AFSOC Weapons and Tactics (AFSOC/A3FW) branch is responsible for oversight and execution of the AFSOC Weapons and Tactics program.

1.2. Tactics Program Goals and Objectives. The goal of the tactics program is to support unit commanders in providing combat-ready aircrews and tactical ground personnel to combatant commanders. Weapons and tactics offices are responsible for understanding operational taskings and ensuring the employment of effective tactical procedures for successful combat operations. Weapons and tactics offices must also analyze AFSOC weapons systems and recommend updates/changes that may impact future operations. This publication provides a framework for establishing, sustaining, and managing an effective unit tactics program. A properly developed unit tactics program should entirely focus on preparing unit personnel in effective planning, employment, and assessment of tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTP). In those situations where published TTP and equipment are lacking, the unit tactician is responsible for identifying changes in the tactical environment, proposing solutions, and sharing information vertically and laterally. An effective tactics program will:

1.2.1. Prepare units in the execution of Designated Operational Capability (DOC), Operations Plans (OPLAN) taskings, Aviation Unit Prep Message (AUPM) and Special Operations Force Generation (FORGEN) requirements.

1.2.2. Ensure training supports unit Mission Essential Task Lists (METL).

1.2.3. Provide a reliable source for planning, employment decision-making, and a realistic assessment of combat capability at all levels.

1.2.4. Validate existing TTP on a continual basis.

1.2.5. Provide for active participation in the development of new TTP.

1.2.6. Manage and disseminate cross flow of relevant tactics information among AFSOC units and appropriate outside organizations.

1.2.7. Serve as the operations focal point for weapons and munitions issues.

1.2.8. Serve as the focal point for external tactical training support.

1.2.9. Ensure tactics program development, implementation, and sustainment.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. General. Commanders at every level are responsible for providing combat-ready aircrews and ground personnel to the Combatant Commander. Each unit's weapons and tactics program should focus significant effort on instructing unit personnel on proper planning, employment, and assessment of published TTP and equipment. In those situations where published TTP and equipment are lacking, it is the responsibility of the unit tactician to identify how tactical realities have changed, what the proposed solutions are, and share that information both vertically and laterally.

2.2. Capabilities/Mission Assessment. Tacticians must ensure unit tactical employment capabilities meet unit mission requirements. Unit tacticians may use combat and contingency operations, Verification Planning Exercises (VPE), Certification Exercises (CERTEX), Validation Exercises (VALEX), Joint Readiness Exercises, flag exercises, and other joint exercises to evaluate/validate unit tactics, equipment, and training. Deficiencies should be forwarded via the chain of command using a Tactics Improvement Proposal (TIP), Tactics After Action Review (TAAR), or other appropriate method/process. Processes described in the following chapters assist in satisfying this requirement. **(T-3)**

2.3. Designed Operational Capabilities (DOC) Statements and Mission Essential Task Listings (METL). Tacticians at all organizational levels must monitor their tactical environments and operational requirements to ensure DOC Statements/METLs correctly express capabilities and propose solutions to differences between requirements and capabilities. As a minimum, review the unit's DOC Statement/METL upon assuming duty as a unit tactician and annually by contacting HQ AFSOC/A3TO. Although HQ AFSOC/A3FW is responsible for coordinating and managing the tactics/tactical employment portions of these processes, subordinate units must provide their insight to effectively influence DOC Statements/METLs. Units should submit proposed changes to DOC Statements and/or METLs through operational command channels. **(T-2)**

2.4. HQ AFSOC Weapons & Tactics (AFSOC/A3FW).

2.4.1. Serve as the office of primary responsibility (OPR) for the AFSOC Weapons and Tactics program and holds responsibility for policy and oversight. This includes administration of the program and headquarters level concept and capabilities development efforts.

2.4.1.1. Review Operational Plans (OPLAN), Contingency Plans (CONPLAN), and MAJCOM/USAF operational concepts of operation (CONOP) to verify effective tactical employment. This will be accomplished on a continual basis.

2.4.1.2. Serve as Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) for AFSOC-applicable AFTTP 3-1/3 series publications revision process. Additionally, perform final coordination with USAF Warfare Center (USAFWC) for AFTTP release.

2.4.1.3. Monitor each unit's compliance through the Management Internal Control Toolset (MICT) at https://mict.cce.af.mil/ and submit results to AFSOC/A3 and AFSOC/IG. AFSOC/A3FW may participate in IG events as requested or deemed necessary.

2.4.1.4. Coordinate with applicable Headquarters Air Force (HAF), MAJCOM, and Air Force Personnel Center (AFPC) agencies on all "W" prefix manpower actions to ensure

requirements reflect adequate justification for assignment of the "W" prefix IAW DAFMAN 11-415. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.5. Participate in Tri-annual Airdrop Malfunction and Safety Analysis Review Boards (AMSARB). Ensure all units with an airdrop mission identify and analyze airdrop malfunctions using the Department of Defense (DD) Form 1748-2, *Airdrop Malfunction Report*, material deficiencies, and provide input to establish corrective procedures.

2.4.1.6. Review wing aerial delivery review panels (ADRP) conclusions and maintain an ADRP master database. All AFSOC airdrop units will forward ADRP results to AFSOC/A3FW within 14 days of the incident. Refer to AFI 13-210_IP, *Joint Airdrop Inspection Records, Malfunction/Incident Investigations, and Activity Reporting*, Chapter 1 for ADRP procedures. AFSOC/A3FW will recommend ADRP corrective actions to the AFSOC/A3 when significant trending items are identified.

2.4.1.7. Review requests for rigging and airdrop of standard loads using non-standard rigging procedures. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.8. Approve Forward Area Refueling Point (FARP) surveys and publish a master FARP site survey list on the Talon Point survey database at: https://talonpoint.josce.net or https://talonpoint.josce.smil.mil for classified surveys. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.9. Approve waivers, conduct safety of flight reviews, and approve/disapprove drop zone (DZ), Landing Zone (LZ), Helicopter Landing Zone (HLZ), and gunnery range surveys IAW DAFMAN 13-217, *Drop Zone, Landing Zone, and Helicopter Landing Zone Operations*. Final approved surveys will be maintained on the Talon Point survey database at: https://talonpoint.josce.net or: https://talonpoint.josce.smil.mil for classified surveys.

2.4.1.10. Review results of all wing munitions delivery review board (MDRB) following an off range/off target expenditure and/or weapons malfunction. Employment incidents will be managed IAW AFMAN 11-202, Volume 3, AFSOCSUP, *Flight Operations,* and provide any corrective procedures. An archive of MDRB results is provided on the AFSOC/A3FW SIPR SharePoint site. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.11. Conduct selection and award procedures for AFSOC Combat Tactician of the Year Awards in accordance with Air Force Special Operations Command Instruction (AFSOCI) 36-2805, *Directorate of Operations Awards*. Annual winners will be announced at the AFSOC Weapons & Tactics Conference (WEPTAC).

2.4.1.12. Review and evaluate current mission requirements, employment tactics, mission planning routines, and analysis of current and emerging threats through the annual WEPTAC and the special operations forces tactics analysis team (SOFTAT).

2.4.1.13. Coordinate with the 361 Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance Group (ISRG) Special Operations Forces Tactics Adversary Studies Element (SOFTASE) office and appoint a SOFTAT operations co-chair. Information on SOFTAT and the duties of the SOFTASE can be found on SIPR at https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/sites/a2/a2o/A2OA/default.aspx.

2.4.1.14. Convene/chair the annual HQ-level tactics review board (TRB) in conjunction with WEPTAC IAW DAFMAN 11-260. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.15. Participate in HQ AFSOC events as required: Technology and Industry Liaison Office (TILO) engagements, the Configuration Steering Group (CSG); Integrated Process Teams (IPT), Operational Planning Teams (OPT), and Lessons Learned Work Groups (LLWG). **(T-2)**

2.4.1.16. Maintain the AFSOC Tactics Improvement Proposal (TIP) database and Operational Testing Database on the Secure ATIMS site: https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx. 18 SOTES/WT will provide concur/ non-concur recommendations based on the feasibility, suitability, and effectiveness of the proposed tactical solution within four weeks of a TIP being submitted. If concurrence is received, 18 SOTES/WT will action the TIP with available resources. If non-concurred by either A3FW or 18 SOTES/WT, 18 SOTES/WT will coordinate with the TIP sponsor and determine follow-on actions (rescope, specify objectives, etc.). **(T-2)** Reference paragraph **3.2.** of this publication for detailed information.

2.4.1.17. Act as tactical advisor to the AFSOC/A3 and AFSOC/A5/8 for weapons system modifications and new capabilities. Designate primary and alternate action officers for the formulation, development, demonstration, and assessment of concepts, mission needs, and requirements for the development and fielding of new concepts and capabilities. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.18. Participate in the Tactics Interfly Program (TIFP) to broaden knowledge and experience.

2.4.1.19. Facilitate tactics information distribution and crosstell by maintaining both SIPR ATIMS https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx and NIPR ATIMS https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/AFSOC-TIMS/SitePages/Home.aspx. **(T-2)**

2.4.1.20. Develop and validate test, training, combat fly-away, and War Reserve Materiel requirements for command and AFSOC gained Guard and Reserve units. Provide those requirements to both HQ AF/A5RW and SOCOM/J4 in an annual forecast. Coordinate with subordinate units to ensure the forecast is complete and meets all mission needs.

2.4.1.21. Ensure model managers are assigned to AFTTP re-write conferences. **(T-2)**

2.4.2. **Command Weapons Officer (CWO).**

2.4.2.1. Serve as the primary advisor to AFSOC/A3 for all operational weapons and tactics related issues within the command.

2.4.2.2. Responsible for the management of all AFSOC 11S/12S weapons officers and will monitor the placement of weapons officers to ensure payback on investment per DAFMAN 11- 415. Coordinates with AFSOC/A1 and 14 WPS in this role.

2.4.2.3. Serve as the primary liaison to the USAF Weapons School (USAFWS) and 14th Weapons Squadron (14 WPS).

2.4.2.4. Represent AFSOC on the USAFWS Selection Board.

2.4.2.5. Provide senior leadership to Wing/Squadron Tactics offices.

2.4.3. **Command Electromagnetic Warfare Officer (CEWO).**

2.4.3.1. Serve as the primary advisor to AFSOC/A3 for all electromagnetic warfare issues within the command.

2.4.3.2. Set the priorities for AFSOC Electronic Combat Support Flight (ECSF) at Robins AFB to align with warfighter requirements.

2.4.3.3. Review and recommend changes to the command's threat priorities list.

2.4.3.4. In conjunction with ECSF, conduct COMMANDO SHIELD EW assessments per DAFMAN 10-703 for each AFSOC wing.

2.4.3.5. Review EW-related test plans, after action reports, and test results to understand potential impacts to AFSOF tactics and EW capabilities.

2.4.3.6. Manage the AFSOC Electronic Combat Officer Course. As a minimum, conduct two courses annually, varying locations as appropriate. Maintain a database of course graduates.

2.5. 18 Special Operations Test and Evaluation Squadron Tactics Development (18 SOTES/WT).

2.5.1. Develop AFSOF capabilities through innovative tactics, technology, and training. Serve as the OPR for tactics development including tactical preparation for combat operations and leading the Tactics Development and Improvement Program (TDIP).

2.5.2. Serve as lead facilitator for evaluation, development, and validation of AFSOC TTP. **(T- 2)**

2.5.3. Determine appropriate method of TTP validation: tactics development and evaluation (TD&E) or stakeholder consensus through weapons officer concurrence.

2.5.4. Author concepts of employment (CONEMP) for AFSOC weapons systems and provide tactics subject matter expertise in support of TD&E, operational tests (OT), and developmental tests (DT).

2.5.5. Coordinate with TIP sponsors to develop test requests, deliverables, and timelines.

2.5.6. Participate throughout the test process and integrate tactical considerations within the test plan.

2.5.7. Continually review and evaluate current mission requirements, employment tactics, mission planning routines, and analysis of current and emerging threats in coordination with SOFTASE to identify tactical requirements and deficiencies. **(T-2)**

2.5.8. Observe ground and flight operations during AFSOC exercises that include OT&E/TD&E events. At a minimum, this should include EMERALD WARRIOR, SOFEX, and USAFWS Integration Phase (WSINT). **(T-2)**

2.5.9. Coordinate with superior, equivalent, and/or subordinate units as necessary ensuring crosstell and maintaining awareness of potential issues of local and potential MWS-wide impacts. This may include periodic contact with tactics offices outside the MAJCOM, wing, or group that operate the same MDS or have similar mission employment tasking. **(T-2)**

2.5.10. Participate in other MAJCOM WEPTACs, HQ AFSOC LLWG, post deployment after action reports, USAFWS paper presentations, SOFTAT, AFTTP working groups, National Defense Industry Association (NDIA) sponsored events and Gatekeeper meetings. Conduct visits to DoD/DoD-sponsored laboratories supporting AFSOC operational capabilities and future operating requirements. **(T-2)**

2.5.11. Ensure systems and capabilities are fielded with baseline TTP. **(T-2)**

2.5.12. Develop CONEMP supporting TD&E, OT, and DT of emerging materiel or tactical solutions.

2.5.13. Early Influence enables engagement and teaming activities between end users and acquisition communities early in the acquisition process thereby reducing program risk and supporting the delivery of mission capable systems to the warfighter. **(T-2)**

2.5.14. Support AFSOC warfighters in the formulation, development, demonstration, and assessment of concepts, mission needs, and requirements for the development of new capabilities to support Combat Mission Need Statements (CMNS), Joint Urgent Operational Need (JUON) and Joint Emergent Operational Need (JEON) requirements, and technology experimentation. **(T-2)**

2.5.15. Participate in TILO Meetings, CSGs and IPTs as necessary. **(T-2)**

2.5.16. Review Lessons Learned Working Group (LLWG) submissions ensuring parallel efforts are not currently in work. **(T-2)**

2.5.17. Ensure the office is manned with an officer and enlisted member for each AFSOC MWS to support tactics development activities across the spectrum of AFSOC capabilities (IAW AFMAN 11- 415). Unlike other MAJCOMs, AFSOC lacks a Numbered Air Force, Center or Test and Evaluation Wing to conduct the TDIP; the 18 SOTES/WT will organize into functional areas manned with officer, enlisted and civilian personnel. These positions will be manned by WIC/AIC tier 2 graduates unless a WIC/AIC does not exist for a particular MWS. Additionally, the Chief of 18 SOTES/WT will be a USAFWS graduate. **(T-2)**

2.5.18. Serve as Office of Coordinating Responsibility (OCR) for AFSOC-applicable AFTTP 3-1/3 series publications revision process. Coordinate with USAFWC/561 Weapons Squadron for conference attendance.

2.6. Special Operations Wing (SOW) Weapons and Tactics Office.

2.6.1. Responsible for executing the wing's weapons and tactics program and serve as the focal point to the SOW/CC for tactical employment of all combat resources. These responsibilities include administration, tactical preparation for combat operations, leading the wing TDIP, and overseeing tactical training and assessment.

2.6.2. Review OPLANS/CONPLANS and CONOPS impacting SOW area of responsibility for currency and relevancy. Recommend changes to squadron training plans as necessary.

2.6.3. Conduct annual semi-annual self-assessment checklist using the AFSOCMAN 11-207 checklist in MICT https://mict.cce.af.mil/. **(T-2)**

2.6.4. Conduct annual staff assistance visits (SAV) of subordinate units and monitor each unit's compliance through the Management Internal Control Toolset at: https://mict.cce.af.mil/. **(T-2)**

2.6.5. Observe/Grade CERTEX/VALEX events for SOW Special Operations Task Groups/Units on behalf of SOW/CC.

2.6.6. The wing tactics loadmaster, or designated representative with a malfunction to report, will attend the tri-annual AMSARBs IAW AFI 13-210_IP, *Joint Airdrop Inspection Records,*

Malfunction/Incidents, Investigations and Activity Reporting, and prepare a summary report for all units with an airdrop mission within the wing. Provide a copy of this report to AFSOC/A3FW via the organization email: afsoca3.a3fw.WeaponsandTactics@us.af.mil. **(T-2)**

2.6.7. The wing tactics loadmaster will host an airdrop symposium at least once each semi-annual period (ARC Annual if waived by OG/CC) for all loadmasters from units with an airdrop mission. These symposiums disseminate information from recent AMSARBs in addition to discussing lessons learned and on-going initiatives. **(T-3)**

2.6.8. Submit approval requests for rigging and airdrop of standard loads using non- standard rigging to HQ AFSOC/A3FW via the organization email: afsoca3.a3fw.WeaponsandTactics@us.af.mil. **(T-2)**

2.6.9. Identify and analyze airdrop incidents, malfunctions, and material deficiencies; provide input to establish corrective procedures by chairing ADRPs to investigate all airdrop incidents or malfunctions IAW AFI 13-210_IP, DAFMAN 13-217, and local guidance. Convene the ADRP no later than the next duty day after the airdrop incident occurs for local missions or within five days for off station incidents. Host wing tactics office will appoint an ADRP with appropriate SMEs from the applicable MDS. Forward completed ADRP reports to AFSOC/A3FW via the organization email: afsoca3.a3fw.WeaponsandTactics@us.af.mil within 14 days of the incident after routing through local chain of command. **(T-2)**

2.6.10. Conduct safety of flight reviews and recommend approval/disapproval for drop zone (DZ), Landing Zone (LZ), Helicopter Landing Zone (HLZ), and gunnery range surveys IAW DAFMAN 13-217. Assist squadrons with locating current surveys for upcoming training, exercise, or contingency events. Monitor survey expiration dates and coordinate for zones to be resurveyed as required. **(T-3)**

2.6.11. Research compatibility of locations for potential FARP use, survey new FARP sites, and forward completed FARP surveys to AFSOC/A3FW via Talon Point for final approval IAW AFI 11-235, *Specialized Refueling Operations*. **(T-2)**

2.6.12. Munitions Delivery Review Board. Wing tactics will investigate all weapon failures, known/suspected malfunctions, and any large unpredicted misses. Detailed information regarding weapons employment issues can be found in AFMAN 11-202V3_AFSOCSUP. Reference AFMAN 11-202V3_AFSOCSUP, Attachment 10 and AFSOC/A3V FCIF for the required information collected regarding a weapons malfunction. The chief of tactics will review the completed investigative report and submit recommendations to the wing commander. A copy of the report will be forwarded through the wing commander to AFSOC/A3FW for review and analysis. **(T-2)**

2.6.13. Coordinate with AFSOC/A3 for training, contingency, and deployment munitions requirements (quantity and type) IAW AFMAN 11-212, *Requirements for Aircrew Munitions.*

2.6.14. Appoint a tactician to serve as the focal point for munitions-related efforts IAW AFMAN 11-212 and DAFMAN 21-201, *Munitions Management*. This position will not be filled by a USAFWS graduate to avoid confusion. This tactician is the conduit between AFSOC/A3FW and the SOW/A3. **(T-3)**

2.6.15. Coordinate with wing-level LLWG analysts ensuring issues raised to HQ AFSOC/LLWG do not duplicate efforts or circumvent the TRB process. **(T-2)**

2.6.16. Ensure AAR submissions are validated by appropriate MDS SME for accuracy before review by the LLWG.

2.6.17. Oversee remediation of AAR observations that are determined to be tactical in nature.

2.6.18. Promote and support the transformation of tactics AAR observations into TIPs.

2.6.19. Promote cross-tell, accomplish an intra-fly sortie on each airframe within the wing at least once per semiannual period in accordance with Tactics Intra-Fly Program (TIFP), paragraph **4.8** of this publication. **(T-3)**

2.6.20. Maintain a record of wing intra-fly participation for two years. **(T-2).**

2.6.21. Document noteworthy observations on a TAAR (See Figure 4.2 for an example TAAR format). **(T-2)**

2.6.22. Ensure all wing/unit tacticians complete AFSOC Tactics Management Training (TMT) within 120 days of being assigned to a tactics office (N/A for USAFWS graduates). TMT will be instructed by a weapons officer/AIC graduate, chief of wing tactics, or a wing commander's designated alternate using the approved TMT courseware located on the A3FW SharePoint site: https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFSOC-A3/AFSOC-A3F/A3FW. **(T-3)**

2.6.23. Appoint wing tacticians utilizing the appointment letter template. (See **Attachment 2** for example). **(T-3)**

2.6.24. Designate a Chief of Wing Weapons and Tactics. The chief will be a USAFWS graduate IAW DAFMAN 11-415. (not applicable for AFSOC gained ANG or AFRC). **(T-2)**

2.6.25. Designate an Electronic Warfare Officer (EWO), Combat Systems Officer (CSO), Electronic Combat Pilot/Officer (ECP/ECO) or an Electronic Counter Measures Officer/Technician (ECMO/T) assigned. This position will be a graduate of either: USAF Electronic Warfare School, AFSOC Electronic Combat Officer Course, Fighter Electronic Combat Officers Course, Mobility Electronic Combat Officers Course or Introduction to Electronic Warfare. Wings or squadrons without these qualified personnel will designate the most qualified individual to perform Electronic Warfare/Combat responsibilities within the tactics office IAW DAFMAN 11-415. **(T-2)**

2.6.26. Ensure wing tactics offices are manned with an officer and enlisted member for each assigned MWS. These positions will be manned by WIC/AIC tier 2 graduates unless a WIC/AIC does not exist for a particular MWS. ANG/AFRC tactician positions may be filled by either traditional or full-time Guardsmen/Reservists and will be assigned to the tactics office as their primary duty position. **(T-3)**

2.6.27. Ensure all wing tacticians are instructor qualified, hold a TS/SCI clearance, and maintain Mission Ready/Combat Mission Ready (MR/CMR) status. This affords access to operationally relevant material at elevated classification levels and ensures the tactical expertise required for tactics development and instruction. **(T-3)**

2.6.28. Liaise with intelligence, plans, and wing leadership ensuring all squadron weapons and tactics offices are trained for potential real-world missions, and intended tactics are current and relevant. **(T-2)**

2.6.29. Conduct TRB IAW the guidelines contained in DAFMAN 11-260 and staff Tactical Improvement Proposals (TIP) for action to the AFSOC TRB. **(T-2)**

2.6.30. Participate in the annual AFSOC TRB/WEPTAC. **(T-2)**

2.6.31. Staff, submit, and monitor TIPs using the AFSOC TIP Database located on the secure ATIMs website at: https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx.

2.6.32. Complete TIPs IAW **Chapter 4** of this publication and DAFMAN 11-260. Wing tactics offices have two weeks after a TIP submission to either concur, non-concur, or concur with intent. **(T-2)**

2.6.33. Monitor and review unit all submitted AAR/TAARs for any exercise or unit deployment. TAARs will be completed IAW **Chapter 3** of this publication within 30 days of returning from the exercise or deployment. TAARs will be input into Joint Lessons Learned Information System (JLLIS) at https://www.jllis.smil.mil/ussocom no later than 15 days after completion of the TAAR. **(T-3)**

2.6.34. Conduct and manage the EWIR program IAW DAFMAN 10-703 as supplemented. **(T- 2)**

2.6.35. Observe one Combat Mission Sortie (CMS) for each squadron annually. This will be conducted as part of the TIFP (paragraph **4.8**) and is intended to increase cross-tell and tactical discussion. It will not be combined with no-notice check rides or other unit evaluations. The wing tactician will complete a TAAR IAW **Chapter 4** to capture noteworthy practices and lessons learned. **(T-3)**

2.6.36. Promote cross-tell by distributing pertinent information, articles, newsletters, white papers, and feedback between operational units. **(T-3)**

2.6.37. Participate in monthly AFSOC tactics enterprise video teleconference (VTC).

2.7. Squadron Weapons and Tactics.

2.7.1. Responsible for executing the squadron weapons and tactics program. These responsibilities include administration, tactical preparation for combat operations, leading the Tactics Development and Improvement Program, and overseeing tactical training and assessment. Squadron tacticians will be appointed by squadron operations officer and forwarded to AFSOC/A3FW, reference **Attachment 2**. **(T-2)**

2.7.2. Conduct semi-annual self-inspections via MICT: https://mict.cce.af.mil. **(T-3)**

2.7.3. Ensure squadron loadmaster tacticians from units with an airdrop mission attend the airdrop symposiums convened by wing loadmaster tacticians. If the office loadmaster tactician is unable to attend, squadrons will provide an alternate. Provide updates on airdrop operations (to include incidents/malfunctions) during recent contingency, exercise, or training missions and recommending possible changes to procedures, rigging, TTP, etc., as applicable. **(T-3)**

2.7.4. Identify and analyze airdrop incidents, malfunctions, and material deficiencies; provide input to establish corrective procedures & will notify wing weapons and tactics of any airdrop incidents or malfunctions IAW AFI 13-210_IP, DAFMAN 13-217, and local guidance. This will occur for all airdrop incidents or malfunctions no later than the next duty day after the incident occurs for local missions or within five days for off station incidents. Squadron tactics offices will support the wing ADRP for any airdrop incidents or malfunctions. **(T-2)**

2.7.5. Submit requests for rigging and airdrop of nonstandard loads and nonstandard rigging of standard loads IAW MDS Vol 3. **(T-2)**

2.7.6. Identify DZ, LZ, HLZ, and gunnery ranges requiring surveys/updates. **(T-3)**

2.7.7. Research approved FARP sites against requirements or request new site surveys. Loadmasters who have completed Advanced Tactical Readiness (ATR) may assist wing tactics in performing FARP surveys. **(T-3)**

2.7.8. Serve as OPR for training, contingency, and deployment munitions requirements (quantity and type) IAW AFMAN 11-212. **(T-3)**

2.7.9. Conduct and support the EWIR program IAW DAFMAN 10-703. **(T-3)**

2.7.10. Ensure all squadron members have access to either the AFSOC weapons and tactics library or a local unit weapons and tactics library. The classified AFSOC library is located at: https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx and: https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/AFSOC-TIMS/SitePages/Home.aspx for unclassified publications. **(T-2)**

2.7.11. Ensure all unit tacticians complete AFSOC TMT within 120 days of being assigned to a tactics office (N/A to USAFWS graduates). TMT should be instructed by a weapons officer/AIC graduate, or the Chief of Wing Tactics using the approved TMT courseware located on A3FW SharePoint, https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFSOC-A3/AFSOC-A3F/A3FW. **(T-3)**

2.7.12. Ensure squadron tactics offices are manned with an officer and enlisted member for each MWS position. These positions will be manned by WIC/AIC tier 1 graduates unless a WIC/AIC does not exist for a particular MWS. ANG/AFRC tactician positions may be filled by either traditional or full-time Guardsmen/Reservists and will be assigned to the tactics office as their primary duty position. **(T-3)**

2.7.13. Ensure the Chief of Squadron Weapons and Tactics is a USAFWS graduate (not applicable for squadrons without an established MWS weapons instructor course or AFSOC gained ANG or AFRC). **(T-2)**

2.7.14. Designate an Electronic Warfare Officer (EWO), Combat Systems Officer (CSO), Electronic Combat Pilot/Officer (ECP/ECO) or an Electronic Counter Measures Officer/Technician (ECMO/T) This position will be a graduate of either: USAF Electronic Warfare School, AFSOC Electronic Combat Officer Course, Fighter Electronic Combat Officers Course, Mobility Electronic Combat Officers Course or Introduction to Electronic Warfare. Squadrons without these qualified personnel will designate the most qualified individual to perform Electronic Warfare/Combat responsibilities within the tactics office IAW DAFMAN 11-415, Weapons and Tactics Program. **(T-2)**

2.7.15. At a minimum, tactics office manning will meet or exceed the minimum quotas outlined in this publication. **(T-3)** Squadron tacticians will maintain Mission Ready/Combat Mission Ready (MR/CMR) status and have Top-Secret security clearances. **(T-3)** This provides access to operationally relevant material at elevated classification levels and ensures tactical expertise required for tactical development and instruction. **(T-2)**

2.7.16. For AD/AFRC or AD/ANG Total Force Integrated (TFI) squadrons, joint squadron tactics offices are acceptable provided all AFRC/ANG contributions are based on full-time equivalent manning (3 AFRC/ANG = 1 full time equivalent). **(T-2)**

2.7.17. Support unit review of submitted TAARs and AARs for tactics related observations. Ensures tactics data is presented accurately within TAARs and AARs and promotes remedy submission via TIPs. Facilitates Wing Tactics submitted RFIs to TAAR/AAR, TIP, and Lessons Learned mediation.

2.7.18. Squadron responsibilities for tactical preparation for combat operations.

2.7.18.1. Review squadron DOC Statement and METLs annually to ensure that tactics and tactical employment capabilities support mission requirements. Recommend document revisions to unit leadership when applicable. **(T-3)**

2.7.18.2. Be familiar with all known unit employment taskings (i.e., specified in standing OPLANs or CONPLANs) to ensure unit crew members are prepared to meet such requirements. **(T-2)**

2.7.18.3. Provide direction to squadron training using CMT and CMS to ensure the unit is training for potential real-world missions, and ensure intended tactics are current and relevant. **(T-2)**

2.7.19. Squadron Tactics Development and Improvement Program.

2.7.19.1. Assess squadron tactics, tactical employment, and capabilities on a continual basis. This will ensure currency, validity, and effectiveness**. (T-3)**

2.7.19.2. Conduct squadron-level TRB IAW the guidelines contained in DAFMAN 11-260 and route TIPs for action. Reference **Chapter 3** of this publication for procedure. **(T-3)**

2.7.19.3. Participate in the annual AFSOC TRB/WEPTAC. **(T-2)**

2.7.19.4. Host annual tactics working groups. Disseminate information as widely as necessary. Provide results to wing tactics. **(T-3)**

2.7.19.5. Staff, submit, and monitor TIPs using the AFSOC TIP Database located on the secure ATIMs website. TIPs will be completed IAW **Chapter 3** of this publication and DAFMAN 11-260. **(T-2)**

2.7.19.6. Submit and monitor TAAR for any exercise, Joint Combined Exchange Training (JCET), or unit deployment. TAARs will be submitted IAW **Chapter 4** of this publication. TAARs will be submitted to wing within 14 days of returning from the exercise or deployment. **(T-2)**

2.7.19.7. Identify and define training and support equipment deficiencies to support electronic combat and tactical employment. Deficiency reports must be submitted through maintenance Quality Assurance. **(T-3)**

2.7.19.8. Submit AF Form 1067s to AFSOC/A3FW via email at: afsoca3.a3fw.WeaponsandTactics@us.af.mil. Reference **Chapter 3** of this publication for procedures. A3FW will sponsor the modification with the WSIPT and forward to HQ AFSOC/A4MX. **(T-2)**

2.7.20. Squadron Tactics Training and Assessment

2.7.20.1. Coordinate with the training office to schedule and provide CMT on relevant tactics topics such as review of unit employment plans. This training will be focused on current tactics and emerging threats. Reference **Chapter 4** for more details. **(T-2)**

2.7.20.2. Instruct MDS-relevant threat counter tactics/countermeasures procedures to all aircrew members. Provide system recognition and counter tactics training for all relevant threats using all means available including weapon system training devices, and HQ AFSOC-approved training software (e.g. Threat Signal Recognition Training System (TSRTS), Global Air Tactics Employment Review (GATER) II/III and/or Real World Air Combat Environment (RW ACE), ARMS Task ID: (G073) (N/A for units with aircraft without defensive systems installed). **(T-2)**

2.7.20.3. Coordinate with the training office, plans, aircrew, operations officer, and unit commander to schedule quarterly Verification Planning Exercises (VPE) and a Verification Review Boards (VRBs) at the conclusion of any VPEs. Reference **Chapter 4** for more details. **(T-3)**

2.7.20.4. Coordinate with the training office, commander, and aviation resource management (ARMS) to provide CMS scenario/requirements and ensure appropriate training is conducted. Reference **Chapter 4** for more details. **(T-3)**

2.7.20.5. Ensure unit aircrew members accomplish a combat mission sortie that simulates all requirements associated with planning, flying, and debriefing. Either a tactician or qualified instructor should observe CMS execution. **(T-3)**

2.7.20.6. Develop and implement testing procedures for tactical employment open book exams. All aircrew members will satisfactorily complete a 40-question test at least once every 17 months (ARMS Task ID: G146). Tactical employment/threat open book exams may be aligned with an aircrew members' periodic flight evaluation. Test questions will be taken from the secure question bank and be relevant to the member's crew position. Testing forms will be maintained for 17 months following test administration. **(T-3)**

2.7.20.7. Support wing tactics to ensure all Munitions Delivery Review Board information is completed IAW AFMAN 11-202V3_AFSOCSUP. **(T-2)**

2.8. AFSOC Formal Training Unit (FTU) Weapons and Tactics Office.

2.8.1. Responsible for ensuring tactical relevancy across AFSOC's Formal Training Units. These responsibilities include administration, ensuring squadron instructors maintain tactical relevance, leading the TDIP, overseeing tactical training and assessment, and ensuring adequate airspace, range, courseware, training scenario, and simulator support for AFSOC FTUs. **(T-3)**

2.8.2. Ensure training incorporates operationally relevant scenarios that introduces students to current planning and employment environments. **(T-3)**

2.8.3. Participate in all applicable MDS formal syllabus of instruction (SOI) rewrites to ensure tactical relevance. **(T-3)**

2.8.4. Coordinate with contract oversight representatives (COR) and government flight representatives (GFR) to ensure contractor support to training operations remains tactically relevant. **(T-3)**

2.8.5. Ensure the development of relevant scenarios and procedures are utilized for tactical training missions. **(T-3)**

2.8.6. Act as OCR for FTU publications and scenarios pertaining to training, exercise and evaluations to ensure relevant tactics are employed. **(T-3)**

2.8.7. Coordinate closely to ensure standardization and evaluation examiners remain aware of all current combat employment concepts. **(T-3)**

2.8.8. Develop procedures for timely dissemination of tactical and intelligence information to applicable MDS training programs. **(T-3)**

2.8.9. Maintain liaison with lateral units to increase training effectiveness and realism using outside assets (e.g., ranges, command and control systems, support aircraft, threat simulators). **(T-3)**

2.8.10. Supervise applicable Range Control Officer Program. **(T-3)**

2.8.11. Ensure FTU tactics offices are manned with an officer and enlisted member for each MWS position in the supported FTU. These positions will be manned by WIC/AIC tier 1 graduates unless a WIC/AIC does not exist for a particular MWS. All tacticians will be instructors and hold a TS/SCI clearance. This will afford access to operationally relevant material at elevated classification levels and to ensure the tactical expertise required for tactics development and instruction. **(T-2)**

2.9. HQ AFSOC/A1.

2.9.1. Manage AFSOC USAFWS graduate outplacement in coordination with HQ AFSOC/A3FW and IAW DAFMAN 11-415. **(T-2)**

2.9.2. Provide nominees and coordinate with HQ ACC for the 14 WPS commander and operations officer positions. **(T-2)**

2.9.3. Support the annual AFSOC WEPTAC/TRB with representatives appropriate to topics scheduled for discussion. **(T-2)**

2.10. HQ AFSOC/A2.

2.10.1. Support the annual AFSOC WEPTAC/TRB with representatives appropriate to topics scheduled for discussion. **(T-2)**

2.10.2. Appoint the intelligence co-chair for the SOFTAT. **(T-2)**

2.10.3. Provide information on worldwide TATs and coordinate for HQ AFSOC attendance/feedback. **(T-2)**

2.10.4. Provide intelligence, analysis, and attendance in support of AFSOC-owned AFTTP volume rewrite conferences. **(T-2)**

2.10.5. Disseminate enemy tactics information to 18 SOTES/WT, AFSOC/A3FW, and subordinate units through appropriate intelligence channels including AFTTP 3-1/3-3 series inputs. **(T-2)**

2.11. HQ AFSOC/A4.

2.11.1. Support the annual AFSOC WEPTAC/TRB with representatives appropriate to topics scheduled for discussion. **(T-2)**

2.11.2. Coordinate with AFSOC/A3FW on deficiency reports impacting tactical employment. **(T-2)**

2.11.3. Coordinate with AFSOC/A3FW on modification proposals (AF Form 1067), impacting tactical employment. **(T-2)**

2.12. HQ AFSOC/A5/8.

2.12.1. Support the annual AFSOC WEPTAC/TRB with representatives appropriate to topics scheduled for discussion. **(T-2)**

2.12.2. Provide program status briefings to support tactical employment decisions. **(T-2)**

Table 2.1. AFSOC/A3FW Publication Responsibilities.

Publication / Form	Title	Duty
Agile Munitions Support Tool (AMST)	Ground Munitions Allocation Tables (GMAT)	Coord
DAFMAN 10-703	Electronic Warfare Integrated Reprogramming	Coord
DAFI 10-706	Electromagnetic Warfare (EW)	Coord
AFMAN 10-3500 Series	Air Force Special Warfare Training, Standardization, and Operations	Coord
AFMAN 11-231	Computed Air Release Point Procedures	Coord
DAFMAN 11-260	Tactics Development Program	Coord
DAFMAN 11-415	Weapons and Tactics Programs	Coord
AFMAN 11-2 Mission Design Series (MDS)	Aircrew Training, Standardization, and Operations	Coord
AFMAN 11-212	Munitions Requirements for Aircrew Training	Coord
AFMAN 13-212 V1	Range Planning and Operations	Coord
DAFMAN 13-217	Drop Zone and Landing Zone Operations	Coord
AFI 13-217_AFSOCSUP	Drop Zone and Landing Zone Operations	Coord
AFI 13-210_IP	Joint Airdrop Inspection Records, Malfunction/Incident Investigations, and Activity Reporting	Coord
T.O. 13C7-1-(Series)	Joint Airdrop Rigging Technical Orders	Coord
AFI 11-235	Specialized Fueling Operations	Publish

Publication / Form	Title	Duty
AFI 10-3503	Personnel Parachute Operations	Coord
AFI 16-1301	Survival, Evasion, Resistance, and Escape (SERE) Program	Coord
AFSOCMAN 11-207	AFSOC Tactics Program	Publish
AFTTP 3-1 MDS Series	Tactical Employment	Publish
AFTTP 3-3 MDS Series	Combat Aircraft Fundamentals	Publish
AFSOC Tactics Handbooks	Tactical Employment	Publish
AF Form 4326	Tactics Improvement Proposal	Action/Publish

Chapter 3

TACTICS DEVELOPMENT AND IMPROVEMENT PROGRAM (TDIP)

3.1. General. AFSOC's TDIP develops, documents, and disseminates tactics to continuously sharpen AFSOC's combat capability. The program includes multiple avenues for addressing tactical employment improvement: test requests, immediate war requirements, aircraft modification requests, Urgent Operational Needs (UON), Combat Mission Need Statements (CMNS), change of flight manual, TAAR, TIP, and the TRB. **(T-2)**

3.2. Tactics Improvement Proposal (AF 4326). Use AF Form 4326 IAW DAFMAN 11-260, to address a tactical deficiency or adopt new or previously undocumented tactical procedures. See Figure 3.1 for the full process. **(T-2)**

3.2.1. If the TIP is an immediate concern and will impact current operations or testing, the TIP will follow an accelerated routing pace. The speed of routing will be dictated by the circumstances requiring tactics development; however, each level of authority should be notified concurrent with headquarters routing. **(T-2)**

3.2.2. Utilize the AFSOC TIP Workflow located on the SIPR ATIMs site for routing procedures. All TIPs must be reviewed, validated, and annotated by the WG/CC for MAJCOM acceptance. After TIP submission, wing weapons and tactics will concur/non-concur within two weeks and 18 SOTES/WT will concur/non-concur within four weeks. It is highly encouraged to submit TIPs without delay for the annual TRB. **(T-2)**

3.2.3. TIPs submitted by ANG/AFRC units should be concurrently submitted to appropriate ANG/AFRC tactics offices and 18 SOTES/WT. **(T-2)**

3.3. Tactics Review Board (TRB). AFSOF, to include associated/gained ANG/AFRC units, will use the guidelines contained in DAFMAN 11-260 to conduct TRBs. **(T-2)**

3.3.1. Squadron weapons and tactics offices will convene a TRB NLT 30 days prior to their respective wing weapons and tactics TRB each year. Forward results to the operations wing weapons and tactics office within 20 calendar days. **(T-3)**

3.3.2. Wing weapons and tactics offices will convene a TRB IAW DAFMAN 11-260 No Later Than (NLT) 30 days prior to the MAJCOM level TRB each year. Forward results and or WG/CC TIP endorsement letter to 18 SOTES/WT within 20 calendar days. **(T-2)**

3.4. Quick Look Project/Immediate War Requirement. The AFSOC/A3 can request immediate test support for requirements or deficiencies that could result in injury, damage, or loss of AFSOC personnel or resources via either the Quick Look Project or Immediate War Requirement processes. Refer to AFSOC HOI 71-5 for further guidance and coordinate with 18 SOTES/WT for submission. **(T-2)**

3.5. Aircraft Modification Requests (AF 1067). Use AF Form 1067, *Modification Proposal*, to request an AFSOC aircraft modification. The AF Form 1067 must be used to document all modifications that change the form, fit, function, or interface per DAFI63-101/20-101 Chapter 9, *Modification Management* of a configured item (aircraft) as determined by the responsible System Program Director (SPD).

3.5.1. Modification proposals require specific funding and approval procedures based on dollar cost. Air Force Requirements Development Guidebook, Volumes 1-5, AFSOC Operational Capability Requirements Development and Service Requirements Process, DAFI 63-101_20-101, *Integrated Life Cycle Management,* Chapter 9, Modification Management and AFSOCI 63-1131, *Modification Management*, outline the dollar limits and procedures for submitting the AF Form 1067.

3.5.2. Tactics offices will submit AF Form 1067s to AFSOC/A3FW who will sponsor the modification with the WSIPT and forward to AFSOC/A4MX.

3.5.3. The Weapons System Integrated Product Team (WSIPT) leader recommends proposal approval or disapproval to the AFSOC Configuration Steering Group (CSG). Validated CSG modification proposals are forwarded to the respective aircraft SPD for engineering evaluation and Single Manager (SM) Change Control Board (CCB) approval. SM/CCB approval is required prior to all configuration changes. **(T-2)**

3.6. Urgent Operational Need (UON) for Air Force capabilities, and Combat Mission Need Statements (CMNS) for SOF capabilities. A UON or CMNS submission must provide detailed information proving that disapproval would likely result in unacceptable loss of life or critical mission failure. Detailed information for this process is found in USSOCOM Directive 71-4, *Special Operations Forces Capabilities Integration and Development System,* Appendix C, for SOF-peculiar items and the Air Force Requirements Development Guidebook, Volume 2, for all others. Coordinate with AFSOC/A5KR for format, content, and procedure. **(T-2)**

3.7. USAF Deficiency Reporting, Investigation, and Resolution. Requests for software changes and/or equipment failing to perform to specifications should be submitted via the Joint Deficiency Reporting System (JDRS). AFSOC/A4M is responsible for managing these reports and maintenance quality assurance is responsible for the process administration. When a software deficiency impacts tactical employment capability, tacticians should submit an Operational Change Request (OCR) utilizing the JDRS format and coordinate with maintenance quality assurance. Tacticians should monitor the progress of the deficiency report to ensure resolution of the deficiency. See T.O. 00- 35D-54, *USAF Deficiency Reporting, Investigation, and Resolution* for further information. **(T-2)**

3.8. Change of Flight Manual (DAF 847). Use DAF Form 847, when requesting a change to a flight manual. Submit and process all request for changes to flight manuals electronically on an DAF Form 847 through MAJCOM channels IAW AFI 11-215, *Flight Manuals Program*, to AFSOC/A3V. **(T-2)**

3.9. Tactics After Action Reports (TAAR). The TAAR supports the warfighter by providing timely, tactically significant information to the AFSOC tactics database for command-wide dissemination. TAARs are used to share significant tactics/lessons learned for cross-tell purposes. A TAAR highlights a finding of tactical significance needing elevation through coordination with 18 SOTES/WT and AFSOC/A3FW for wider dissemination and/or inclusion into the MWS AFTTP rewrite process. The TAAR will be uploaded into the AFSOC/A9L Lessons Learned database to ensure the widest dissemination. TAARs should provide sufficient detail to “stand alone” without needing to contact the originator for additional information. TAARs will be completed within 30 days of returning from any exercise, LFE/CFE, JCET, or unit deployment. **(T-2)**

3.9.1. After wing weapons and tactics approves a TAAR it will be inputted into the JLLIS database at https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/sites/a39/a9l/default.aspx within 15 days of final approval. JLLIS provides action items for AFSOC/A3FW & 18 SOTES/WT. AFSOC/A9L convenes monthly lessons learned working group (LLWG) with representation from each HQ AFSOC directorate. The LLWG reviews, prioritizes, and assigns OPRs to each issue for action. Unit tacticians will work closely with unit leadership, AFSOC/A3FW, and the USSOCOM Lessons Learned personnel at their wing to staff submissions warranting MAJCOM-level attention and prompt action, especially those with command-wide impact. **(T-2)**

3.9.2. Some TAARs may require immediate AFSOC attention. These TAARs should be identified with ///IMMEDIATE/// at the top of the TAAR submission, marked "I-TAAR", and submitted simultaneously to the wing tactics office and JLLIS database for AFSOC/A3 action. An I-TAAR is reserved for rapid dissemination of tactically significant information to all warfighters and reporting significant tactics information of immediate concern (i.e., SAFIRES, TTP errors, etc.). A I-TAAR can be submitted from any organizational level. 18 SOTES/WT will review all I-TAAR submissions and recommend the appropriate action to AFSOC/A3. **(T-2)**

3.9.2.1. An I-TAAR does not replace or alter established post-mission reports or procedures. An I-TAAR may provide amplifying information of an event identified in a post mission report, which may be included as a supporting document in the submission. An I-TAAR is submitted for informational purposes only and does not authorize deviations from established TTP, flight manuals, or other established guidance. **(T-2)**

3.9.2.2. The mission commander, after consultation/discussion with deployed tacticians, determines whether an event meets the I-TAAR criteria and is responsible for reporting the information accordingly. Extensive review and coordination must be avoided to prevent the delay of disseminating critical employment information. **(T-2)**

3.9.2.3. Due to the time-sensitive nature of an I-TAAR, it may be less formal than the standard TAAR format but should answer the basic questions found in Figure 3.2. Once identified, I- TAARs are posted on the classified AFSOC Tactics Information Management System website at https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx. **(T-2)**

Figure 3.1. AFSOC Tactics Improvement Proposal Process.

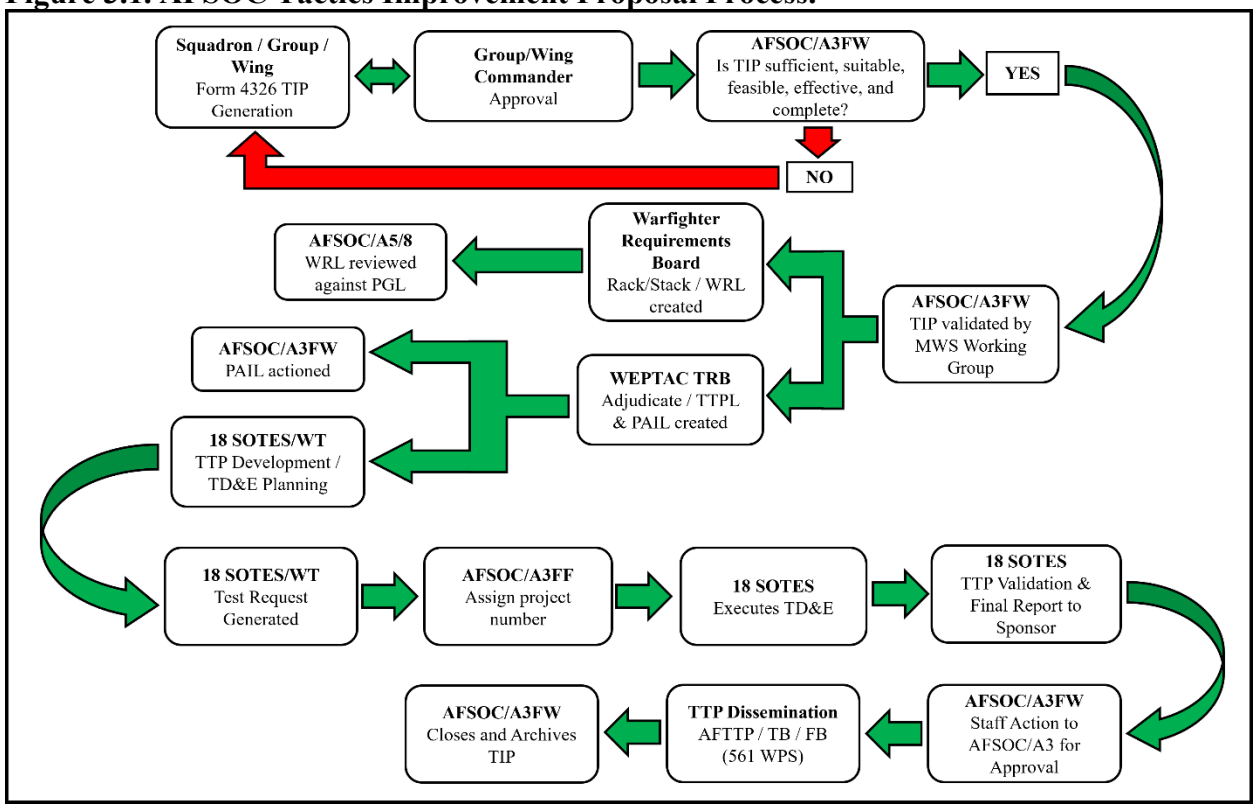


Figure 3.2. TAAR Format.

(CLASSIFICATION)

TACTICS AFTER ACTION REPORT

1. LESSON LEARNED ID AND DATABASE SEQUENCE NUMBER: (assigned by HQ AFSOC)

2. ORIGINATOR: POC Name / Rank / Unit / Contact Info (commercial, DSN, and e-mail address)

3. EVENT NAME: (Classification) Operation/Exercise/Experiment Name {i.e., OEF, OIF, JCET XXXX, JCS Exercise, Multilateral Exercise, Bilateral Exercise, TAAR, etc.}

4. TITLE: (Classification) If an Issue or Observation, start with the title ”Issue” or “Observation.” Mark Classification IAW DoD 5200.1-R.

5. **OBSERVATION:** (Classification Define the (potential) problem.

6. DISCUSSION: (Classification) Provide the who, what, where, when, why, and how.

7. LESSON LEARNED: (Classification) Describe a better process, a work-around, a new solution if any.

8. RECOMMENDATION: (Classification) What is the proposed solution(s) if appropriate.

9. COMMENT: (Classification) Any additional comments that may further define the LL and recommendation.

(CLASSIFICATION)

Chapter 4

TACTICS TRAINING

4.1. General. Squadron tacticians are responsible for ensuring all aircrew members possess strong tactical knowledge to effectively employ their MDS. Additionally, they are responsible for planning and coordinating tactical employment training for aircrew members. Currency requirements for Threat System Recognition Training, CMT, VPE, and CMS are the primary methods of receiving combat training defined in AFMAN 11-2MDS Volume 1 and are intended to provide the knowledge required for aircrews to prepare for and execute their unit's missions. The requirements detailed in this chapter are essential in developing effective squadron training plans and should be coordinated with squadron leadership and training offices.

4.2. Threat System Recognition Training. Conduct IAW AFMAN 11-2MDS Volume 1. Review relevant threat systems using any means available including weapon system training devices, and HQ AFSOC-approved training software (e.g. Threat Signal Recognition Training System, Global Air Tactics Employment Review II/III and/or Real World Air Combat Environment (N/A for units with aircraft without defensive systems)). **(T-2)**

4.3. Combat Mission Training (CMT). CMT programs require the active involvement and support of unit commanders, operations officers, tactics officers, intelligence officers, and all aircrew members. CMT is required for all members as initial and recurring training. The weapons and tactics office is responsible for coordinating with the unit training office to schedule CMT times. Each unit weapons and tactics office is responsible for developing CMT courseware specific to their MWS. CMT should be focused on tactics required for expected threats & unit taskings. At a minimum, unit tactics offices will conduct an annual review of CMT courseware to determine training requirements based on unit taskings, areas of operation, and projected threats. **(T-2)**

4.3.1. Initial CMT is an academic training requirement and provides crew members with the academic knowledge required to plan and execute missions in various hostile environments. This training provides the groundwork for conducting the follow-on VPEs and CMSs. Initial CMT may be accomplished at the formal school in conjunction with a mission qualification course or as part of a local mission qualification course. At a minimum, initial CMT will cover the required topics defined in Table 4.1 and is documented in the Aviation Resource Management System (ARMS). **(T-2)**

4.3.2. Recurring CMT must contain unit mission, Area of Operations (AO) and theater-specific threat information, command and control structures, general threats and weapon system-specific counter tactics/evasive maneuvers. USAFWS graduates, unit intelligence, and tacticians will instruct CMT refresher. CMT, CMS, and/or VPE can be logged by graduates upon completion of USAFWS. **(T- 2)**

4.3.3. Aircrew Intelligence Training. Unit tacticians will coordinate for intelligence personnel to support initial and refresher CMT for aircrew members in threats, intelligence-related areas, and country study briefings. **(T-2)**

4.4. Quarterly Tactics Training. Squadron tacticians will provide, or coordinate with appropriate organizations to develop and support, quarterly tactics briefings on subjects important to the squadron's current mission and tactical employment. Following completion of this training, the instructor should administer a ten question tactics-related test to assess and strengthen the level of

tactics knowledge among unit aircrew members. These tests may focus on the material presented during tactics lectures. Break-out tactics discussions by crew position are also encouraged. Units are required to maintain digital records of quarterly tactics training for one year after the training is completed. **(T-3)**

4.5. Tactical Employment/Threat Open Book Test. Squadron tactics offices are responsible for developing and implementing testing procedures for tactical employment open book exams. All aircrew members will satisfactorily complete a 40-question test in accordance with AFSOC Ready Aircrew Program Tasking Memorandum (RTM) (ARMS Task ID: G146XS). Tactical employment/threat open book exams may be aligned with an aircrew members' periodic flight evaluation. Test questions will be taken from the secure question bank and be relevant to the member's crew position. Minimum passing score is 85 percent. **(T-3)**

4.5.1. Test Failure and Re-examination. In the event of a test failure, notify the squadron operations officer who will direct additional training prior to a retest. Retests will be accomplished no sooner than 24 hours (ARC less than 24hrs if waived by the OG/CC) after the failed test to afford adequate time to review applicable publications and accomplish directed training; additional disciplinary action will be at the discretion of the flying squadron operations officer/commander. The aircrew member will be re-evaluated using an alternate exam which will include no more than 70 percent of the questions included in the initial test. Test scores sheets will be maintained for 17 months after completion of the test. **(T-3)**

4.5.2. Secure Question Banks (SQB). Individual tests are to be relevant to the member's crew position; thus, question banks must be expansive enough to support primary and alternate test versions for each crew position of a given MDS. Derive questions from the following publications: AFTTP 3-1. Integrated Planning and Employment (IPE), AFTTP 3-1. Threat Guide (TG), the respective AFTTP 3-1. (MDS) volume, pertinent defensive system handbooks, squadron CONOPS, and classified aircraft technical orders (as applicable). A common SQB may be used by all units that share a given AFTTP publication, provided the question bank is reviewed at least annually. Do not distribute the SQB to unit aircrews and safeguard it in the same manner as any other required, controlled examination. Change a minimum of 30 percent of the questions on examinations each calendar year. Once removed from the SQB, previous questions may be reused after a 1-year absence if they remain consistent with current publications/tactics. (T-3)

4.5.3. Examination Question Review. Squadron and wing tacticians will review each SQB annually at a minimum. Due to AFTTP rewrites, changes to CONOPS, and/or other significant operational changes, tactics tests may require out-of-cycle reviews. **(T-3)**

4.6. Verification Planning Exercises (VPE). VPEs will be conducted quarterly, or IAW the most current MDS Ready Aircrew Tasking Memo (RTM) and provide the opportunity for aircrews to apply their combat knowledge and skills in a training environment. VPEs provide crews the opportunity to exercise local mission planning support processes such as intelligence, weather, rules of engagement, legal (judge advocate) mission considerations, and refresh crews with real-world mission planning procedures. VPEs should be conducted in conjunction with the unit initial assessment (IA) in support of their OPLAN/CONPLAN or rotational tasking. Participation in the planning and VRB briefing of an operational, contingency, or exercise mission may be substituted for a VPE. Unit commanders will determine which missions satisfy this requirement. **(T-2)**

4.6.1. Specific training events that must be accomplished by each MDS are contained within their respective AFMAN 11-2MDS, Volume 1. In the absence of specific Volume 1 guidance, see **Attachment 3**, Verification Planning Exercises Planning Elements, for essential elements for the accomplishment of VPEs. **(T-2)**

4.6.2. Verification Review Board (VRB). The VRB serves as a "dry run" briefing. The purpose of the board is to provide unit leadership with an opportunity to review the plan and determine its validity. The board should consist of the squadron commander, squadron operations officer, and chiefs of tactics and standardization/evaluation. Additional board members will be designated by the Sq/CC with inputs from the squadron tactics office. **(T-3)**

4.7. Combat Mission Sortie (CMS). The CMS program provides the weapons and tactics chief, training chief, operations officer, and squadron commander a means to focus unit tactical training on current enemy threats and tactical requirements. CMSs should provide aircrew the opportunity to practice/simulate all requirements associated with planning, flying, and debriefing a combat mission within a given theater's AOR. Plan and execute the CMS in the same sequence, using the same planning and briefing formats as a combat or contingency mission. The squadron weapons and tactics office is responsible for coordinating with the unit training office, aviation resource management, operations officer, and squadron commander annually to identify requirements for logging CMS. At a minimum, unit tactics offices will conduct an annual review of CMS requirements to determine training requirements based on unit taskings. A unit tactician or instructor should be on board to log a CMS event and will debrief the tactical employment. **(T-3)**

4.7.1. Newly qualified crew members will acquire exposure to unit and theater-specific procedures and complete a CMS within 90 days of their first flight in their new unit and/or prior to deploying for real-world contingencies. **(T-3)**

4.7.2. In addition to local flying training profiles and at the unit commander's discretion, a CMS may be credited following flying operations during a real-world mission, contingency operation, or any mission in an actual threat environment. Additionally, at unit commander's discretion, flying participation in courses and exercises that enhance learning, tactical employment, and joint or combined operations may credit a CMS. **Attachment 4** contains a CMS observation checklist that may be used as a starting point for unit tacticians to observe aircrew tactics, identify deficiencies, and initiate improvements. **(T-3)**

4.7.3. Wing and squadron tacticians will fly with aircrews to assess the unit's skill in a tactical, unit-developed scenario. Any significant observations, trend items, and/or techniques that warrant squadron-level assessment will be brought to the attention of squadron and/or wing tactics offices. **(T-3)**

4.8. AFSOC Tactics Intra-fly Program (TIFP). Provides the opportunity for tacticians to observe operations while on aircraft from other AFSOC units, to exchange information and ideas, view missions and mission requirements from a different perspective, and assess their own unit's capabilities and limitations based on their observations. In particular, tacticians will pursue opportunities to fly with other AFSOC units that have relationships of customer-provider and mission co-participants. **(T-2)** Aircrew assigned to AFSOC A3FW/18 SOTES may fly as a tactics observer on any AFSOC aircraft, primary assigned or other. Individuals participating in TIFP are responsible for providing the flying unit with all required flight eligibility documents IAW DAFMAN 11-401, *Flight Management*, and will log "other" flight time. For all observation flights, use appropriate portions of the CMS Observation checklist provided in **Attachment 4**.

4.9. Weapons and Tactics Library. AFSOC/A3FW will maintain classified and unclassified libraries containing the publications listed in Table 4.2 and Table 4.3. Squadron weapons and tactics is responsible for either maintaining their own library with current publications or ensure all squadron members have access to the AFSOC Weapons and Tactics Library. Current versions of classified documents are maintained for ease of access at: https://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx and https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/AFSOC-TIMS/SitePages/Home.aspx for unclassified documents. **(T-2)**

4.9.1. AFSOC/A3FW is responsible for coordinating updates to Tactics Handbooks and AFTTP 3-1/3-3 volumes for AFSOC aircraft. AFSOC wing and squadron tacticians must identify potential changes to the publications. Unit tactician representatives are required to participate in volume updates to ensure theater-relevant information is incorporated. The 561st WPS or AFSOC/A3 will publish interim changes or page changes to update publication information between revisions. **(T-2)**

4.9.2. AFSOCMAN 11-207. HQ AFSOC publishes AFSOCMAN 11-207 to define the tactics program, responsibilities, and processes. This document must meet wing and squadron tactics requirements to maintain combat ready aircrews and provide the appropriate expertise to unit leadership. To ensure unit requirements are met, wing and squadron tacticians must take an active part in providing inputs to AFSOCMAN 11-207. **(T-2)**

4.9.3. Other Publications. AFSOC participation in multi-command, joint, and combined operations across the entire spectrum of conflict provides the opportunity to make meaningful contributions to the improvement of many publications that influence AFSOC operations. AFSOC units should provide recommended changes to these publications to 18 SOTES/WT. The 18 SOTES/WT will then coordinate with AFSOC/A3FW to consider these inputs when coordinating on the publications. **(T-2)**

4.9.4. Final/Interim Test Reports. Test reports are prepared and made available by the 18 SOTES. Classified test reports are available via the Defense Technical Information Center (DTIC) page at https://login.dtic.smil.mil/. Unclassified reports are located at https://login.dtic.mil. Tacticians should check these pages periodically for test reports and updates. **(T-2)**

4.10. Major Weapon System (MWS) Wiki Websites. Another information source located on the AFSOC/A3FW SIPR SharePoint are individual MWS Wiki websites. These websites are collaborative in nature and created to share tactical information across the platform. The information found on these sites should be utilized for reference only however, they allow tacticians to share a multitude of valuable information across the AFSOC enterprise via a “one-stop shop” concept. 18 SOTES/WT has the maintenance responsibility for these websites.

Table 4.1. Combat Mission Training Required Topics.

REQUIRED	SUGGESTED
Command and Control (C2)	Combined Forces Air Component Commander (CFACC)
	Joint Forces Air Component Commander (JFACC)
	Joint Special Operations Task Force (JSOTF)
	Air Force Special Operations Base (AFSOB)
	Theater Air Control System (TACS)
	AOC, SOLE, SOTG
	Army Air-Ground System (AAGS)
	CAF Integration, Operational-Level Integration
Employment concepts and Orders of Battle (OB)	Electronic Order of Battle (EOB)
	Ground Order of Battle (GOB)
	Air Order of Battle (AOB)
	Time Sensitive Targeting/Time Critical Targeting (TST/TCT)
	Integrated Air Defense System (IADS)
	EW/Information Operations (IO)
anuals and Publications	DAFMAN 10-703, including AFSOC Sup and AFTTP 3-1/3-3
	JP 3-05, *Special Operations*, JP 3-50, *Personnel Recovery*
	AFDP 3.05, *Special Operations*, AFDP 3-50, *Personnel Recovery*
	USSOCOM Pubs
Support Assets	Airborne Warning and Control System (AWACS) / E-2C
	RC-135 / EP-3 roles and capabilities
	EA-37B Compass Call
	Intelligence Broadcast Receiver (IBR)– Enhanced Situational Awareness (SAMS-ESA)
	Joint tactical support requests
	Suppression of Enemy Air Defenses (SEAD) Destruction of Enemy Air Defenses (DEAD)
	Escort/Rescort, A-10, F-15E, F-16, F-18, Rotary wing
	Intelligence, Surveillance, Reconnaissance, U-2, MC-12, MQ-9, MQ-1C, SUAS

Weather, meteorological, and climatological factors	Effects on unit and enemy operations, ground troop movements, and in-flight operations
Intelligence	Importance of understanding enemy political beliefs, employment doctrine, and motivation
	Targeting cycle
	Threats and target information for planned route of flight
	Production requirement/request for information
	Escape and evasion plan
Space Support	Available space support packages such as Blue Force Tracking and GPS accuracy
ATO/ITO/ACO/SPINS	Safe passage, authentication, and operations codes for PR/CSAR
Communications	Use of secure and nonsecure radio communications
	Use of authentication matrix or alternate means
	Use of jam-resistant communications technology including Have Quick, Single Channel Ground and Airborne Radio System (SINCGARS), and data links
Countering Threats (Enemy/friendly weapons, emphasize most likely to be encountered, defensive maneuvers/counter tactics) IAW applicable AFTTP volumes	Employment doctrine, tactics, techniques and procedures
	Guidance systems
	Capabilities
	Planning considerations
	Electronic indications (if applicable)
	Visual Threat Recognition and Avoidance Trainer (VTRAT)
Route selection and navigation	Chart interpretation/preparation/radar shadowing
	Threat avoidance/degradation/terrain masking
	Turn point selection
	Day/night/weather considerations
	Detection Avoidance Navigation/Threat Avoidance Navigation (DAN/TAN)
	Detection Free Altitude (DFA)
	Threat Penetration (TP) Altitude
	Time-over-Target (TOT)/Time-of-Arrival (TOA) control techniques (e.g., timing legs, extensions, orbits)

Low Level Considerations	Task and crew management
	Terrain Avoidance
	Psychological and physiological factors
Operation and employment applicable defensive equipment	Infrared (IR) countermeasures and flares
	Electronic Attack (EA)
	Radar Warning Receivers (RWR)
	Emissions Control (EMCON)
	Aircraft structural and configuration limitations
	Briefings: Pre-mission planning, operations, crew
	Automated mission planning and rehearsal systems
	In-flight reports: Operations, mission, intelligence
	Judge Advocate (Law of Armed Conflict)

Table 4.2. Tactics Library Publications.

Required Documents/Access	**Medium (minimum)**
AFTTP 3-1. Integrated Planning and Employment (IPE)	Electronic
AFTTP 3-1. Threat Reference Guide	Electronic
AFTTP 3-1. (MWS) Tactical Employment	Electronic
AFTTP 3-3. (MWS) Combat Aircraft Fundamentals	Electronic
MTTP/ALSA (e.g. JFIRE, Brevity, etc.)	Electronic
Defensive System handbooks for equipment installed	Electronic
Applicable MDS Security Classification Guides	Electronic
DAFMAN 10-703. Electronic Warfare (EW) Integrated Reprogramming	Electronic
DAFMAN 11-415. Weapons and Tactics Programs	Electronic
MDS RTM	Electronic
MDS/Crew Position CMR Workbooks	Electronic
MDS/Crew Position ATR Workbooks	Electronic
Applicable test reports Multi-Service Data Distribution System (MSDDS) account http://ngdds-master.eglin.af.smil.mil/default.asp	Electronic Accounts for all tacticians

EW Toolbox account http://ewtoolbox.eglin.af.smil.mil/default.asp	Accounts for all tacticians
Joint Lessons Learned Information System account http://www.jllis.smil.mil/apps/	Accounts for all tacticians
ATIMS (NIPR & SIPR) https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/AFSOC-TIMS/SitePages/Home.aspxhttps://afsoc.sof.socom.smil.mil/teams/ATIMS/default.aspx	External user access, if required
561 WPS website (NIPR & SIPR) https://intelshare.intelink.gov/sites/561jts/SitePages/Home.aspx https://intelshare.intelink.sgov.gov/sites.561jts/default.aspx	External user access, if required
Completed self-inspection checklists	Either electronic *or* printed

Table 4.3. Special Tactics Required Tactics Publications.

AFI 10-3504, *Dive Program*
AFMAN 10-3511, *Pararescue and Combat Rescue Officer Operations*
AFMAN 10-3509, *Air Force Special Warfare Medical Operations*
AFMAN 10-3505, Volume 1, *Joint Terminal Attack Controller (JTAC) Training Program*
AFMAN 10-3505, Volume 2, *Joint Terminal Attack Controller (JTAC) Standardization/Evaluation Program*
AFMAN 13-204, Volume 3, *Air Traffic Control*
DAFMAN 13-217, *Drop Zone, Landing Zone, and Helicopter Landing Operations*
AFMAN 10-3500, Vol 2, *Air Force Special Warfare Standardization and Evaluation*
AFMAN 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operations*
DAFI 31-117, *Arming and Use of Force*
DAFI 36-2670, *Total Force Development*
AFMAN 15-111, *Surface Weather Observations*
AFTTP 3-1/3-3.*Guardian Angel*

ATP 3-18.11, *Special Forces Military Free-Fall Operations*
ETL 09-6, C-130/C-17 Landing Zone Marking Criteria
ETL 02-19, Airfield Pavement Evaluation Standards
JO 7110.65Z, *Air Traffic Control*
FAAO 7220.1C, *Certification and Rating Procedures for Department of Defense (DoD) Personnel*
ATP 3-18.11 *Special Forces Military Free-Fall Operations*
AFMAN 11-420, *Static Line Parachuting Techniques and Training*
JP 3-09, *Joint Fire Support*
AFTTP 3-1/3-3 *Special Tactics*
NAVSEA SS521-AG-PRO-010, *U.S. Navy Diving Manual*
Pararescue Medical Operations Handbook
USSOCOM D350-2, *Joint Air Asset Allocation Program*
USSOCOMD 350-3, *Special Operations Forces Baseline Interoperable Airborne Operations (Parachuting) Training Standards*
USSOCOM M350-4, Vol 1, *Special Operations Forces Baseline Interoperable Combat Diving Training Standards*
USSOCOM D350-4, Vol 2, *Special Operations Forces Baseline Interoperable Training Standards, Maritime Infiltration*
USSOCOM M350-5, *Special Operations Forces Baseline Interoperable Standards for Special Operations Forces Joint Terminal Attack Controller Training*
USSOCOM D350-18, *Special Operations Forces Baseline Interoperable Standards, Special Reconnaissance*

Chapter 5

INTELLIGENCE OFFICER ADMINISTRATION

5.1. Intelligence Weapons Officer (IWO). This section (1) formalizes duties and responsibilities with leadership and stakeholders at all levels throughout squadron, wing, and MAJCOM HQs; (2) prioritizes weight of effort for Tier 1 and Tier 2 IWOs & AIICs in AFSOC; and (3) provides accountability for administrative and inspection purposes, while retaining flexibility to react to situations and opportunities as they arrive.

5.2. Oversight. AFSOC/A2 will be the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) and AFSOC/A2F and AFSOC/A3FW will be the Office of Coordinating Responsibility (OCR) for all matters regarding W14Ns and W1Ns in AFSOC. All W15Ns in AFSOC will work closely with their respective Wing and/or MAJCOM counterparts to ensure they are fully integrated into tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTP) development, advanced instruction, and analysis as their primary duties. Wing commanders are highly encouraged to place Tier 1 IWOs under the supervision of the Senior Intelligence Officer (SIO) who will advise the Wing/CC on W14N utilization in the case of conflict between A2 and A3 tasking and priorities. In accordance with DAFMAN 11-415, Tier 1 and Tier 2 IWOs should not be assigned unrelated additional duties and to the furthest extent possible, IWOs should not be assigned to intelligence flight positions which can be filled by non-IWO personnel.

5.3. Roles and Responsibilities. For the purposes of this guidance, an IWO will refer to both IWIC (W14N) and AIIC (W1N) graduates from the United States Air Force Weapons School. Tier 1 positions are normally filled by first assignment IWOs in support of warfighting units (i.e Wings or Squadrons). The AFSOC Tier 2 position is normally filled with second assignment IWOs at the AFSOC headquarters level.

5.3.1. Wing Intelligence Weapons Officer (Tier 1). Tier 1 IWOs engage with and advise wing and squadron intelligence activities, and will:

5.3.1.1. Serve as organization’s principal instructor and advisor for all unit intelligence training courses and assist in identifying external training courses for continuation training.

5.3.1.2. Develop, coordinate, and integrate all intelligence matters into wing weapons and tactics guidance and policy.

5.3.1.3. Serve as the wing and/or squadron subject matter expert for AOR threats, ISR, PED, OPB, and tactical integration.

5.3.1.4. Serve as a liaison, tactical mentor, and/or wing representative to conferences, exercises, planning, and tactics development events. (Ex: Weapons and Tactics Conferences [WEPTACs], AFTTP conferences, Exercise EMERALD WARRIOR, FMPs, VPEs, etc.).

5.3.1.5. Function as the intelligence representative for wing mission training, exercises, mission planning, readiness and evaluation scenarios, and TTP development.

5.3.1.6. Partner with MDS weapons squadrons, Formal Training Units (FTUs), test functions, and advanced courses to observe, support, and develop TTPs to enhance unit training programs, assess Air Force ISR combat capability, tactics deficiencies, best practices, and advise wing leadership on TTP improvements and solutions.

5.3.1.7. Advise and assist Wing Senior Intelligence Officers (SIO) on readiness, evaluations, performance of assigned intelligence personnel, and ensure the readiness of all wing intelligence functions and capabilities to support Designed Operational Capability (DOC) tasked mission sets.

5.3.1.8. Provide commanders and SIOs with subject matter expertise to enable realistic and effective ISR planning, synchronization, employment, and assessments and assist in unit level intelligence submission of collection requirements in support of tasked missions.

5.3.1.9. Advise on Operations Plans (OPLANs) and Special Access Required (SAR) programs affecting weapons and tactics employment to ensure the organization is prepared to fulfill mission statement wartime tasks.

5.3.1.10. Continue personal and professional development through advanced training courses, exercises participation and education, professional networking maintenance and expansion, and exposure to integration events within and outside of the AFSOC community.

5.3.1.11. Support HQ AFSOC requirements when doing so will have deliberate, defined, and observable benefits for host-wing personnel.

5.3.1.12. In coordination with the AFSOC Tier 2 IWO, recruit and develop WIC/AIIC candidates ensuring ensure readiness for the course through development of skills in mission area knowledge application, instructorship, mission planning, integration, and debriefing.

5.3.1.13. Educate units on USAFWS program/course and provide Tier 1 endorsement of candidate(s) when appropriate.

5.3.2. MAJCOM Intelligence Weapons Officer (Tier 2). The Tier 2 IWO leads AFSOC IW&T program development, implementation, and sustainment. In addition, they facilitate tactics training and improvement efforts of subordinate units and serve as the AFSOC/A2 focal point for the integration of ISR and development of analytical TTPs. Finally, they serve as the initial focal point for communication and mentorship with MAJCOM Tier 1 IWOs and will communicate issues to AFSOC/A2. They will maintain access to SCI, Sub-GAMMA (as necessary), and SAR program materials to support sound TTP development and fielding in Full Spectrum Readiness (FSR) environments as required by MAJCOM-assigned OPLANS. Tier 2 IWOs shall:

5.3.2.1. Serve as the command subject matter expert for global threats, ISR, and integration.

5.3.2.2. Coordinate AFSOC IWO representation to WEPTACs, AFTTP conferences, tactics symposiums, formal training conferences, and instructional series design (ISD) working groups to ensure integration of the special operations mission in all aspects and domains.

5.3.2.3. Serve as intelligence liaison to 14 WPS to observe and integrate in local missions when doing so will have deliberate, defined, and observable benefits for AFSOC intelligence personnel.

5.3.2.4. Provide deliberate professional development, mentorship, and confidential advisement to AFSOC assigned Tier 1 IWOs.

5.3.2.5. Serve as a liaison, tactical mentor, and/or AFSOC/A2 representative to conferences, exercises, planning, and tactics development events.

5.3.2.6. Coordinate IWOs as tactical mentors for external exercises (RED FLAG, GREEN FLAG, RESOLUTE HUNTER, etc.) to gain valuable experience that can be incorporated into AFSOC exercises.

5.3.2.7. Serve as or advise the AFSOC/A2 Co-Chair for Special Operations Forces Tactics Analysis Team (SOFTAT), and advise the oversight, guidance, and employment of the Special Operations Forces Tactics and Adversary Studies Element (SOFTASE).

5.3.2.8. Provide subject matter expertise for intelligence integration of OPLANs and Special Access Programs affecting weapons and tactics employment.

5.3.2.9. Continue personal and professional development through advanced training courses, exercises participation and education, professional networking maintenance and expansion, and exposure to integration events within and outside of the AFSOC community.

5.3.2.10. Support cross-MAJCOM requirements when doing so will have deliberate, defined, and observable benefits for AFSOC personnel.

5.3.2.11. Advise AFSOC/A2 Director on:

5.3.2.11.1. Prioritize IWIC nominees and track their development and preparation to

5.3.2.11.2. Communicate with the 19WPS and HQ AFSOC/A3FW on managing W14N assignments and ensuring integration with USAF weapons and tactics guidance and policy.

5.3.2.11.3. Assess AFSOC Total Force units' readiness and integration of ISR in all aspects of contingency and combat employment.

5.3.2.11.4. Maintain an AFSOC W14N roster and to assist with projected USAFWS outplacement prioritization.

5.3.2.11.5. Solicit Wing SIOs and/or Weapons and Tactics offices for Mission Needs Statements and/or W14N utilization summaries to identify AFSOC W-prefix needs and priority fill positions.

K. JASON DANIELS, Colonel, USAF
Director of Operations

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

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AFDP 3-50, *Personnel Recovery,* 18 March 2020

AFI 10-3504, *Dive Program,* 28 October 2024

AFI 11-215, *Flight Manuals Program*, 24 March 2019

AFI 11-235, *Specialized Fueling Operations,* 31 May 2019

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AFSOCI 63-1131, *Modification Management*, 19 March 2019

AFTTP 3-1. *Integrated Planning & Employment (IPE)*, 19 July 2024

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DAFI 10-706, *Electromagnetic Warfare (EW),* 2 June 2021

DAFI 31-117, *Arming and Use of Force,* 28 January 2025

DAFI 36-2670, *Total Force Development*, 25 June 2020

DAFI 63-101-20-101, *Integrated Life Cycle Management*, 16 February 2024

DAFMAN 10-703, *Electromagnetic Warfare Integrated Reprogramming,* 2 June 2021

DAFMAN 11-260, *Tactics Development Program,* 17 March 2023

DAFMAN 11-415, *Weapons and Tactics Program,* 1 August 2023

DAFMAN 13-217, *Drop Zone, Landing Zone, and Helicopter Landing Zone Operations,* 22 April 2021

DAFMAN 21-20*, Munitions Management,* 23 October 2024

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures,* 18 October 2023

DAFPD 10-7, *Information Operations,* 22 June 2021

JP 3-05, *Special Operations,* 16 July 2014

JP 3-50, *Personnel Recovery,* 20 December 2011

T.O. 00-35D-54, *USAF Deficiency Reporting, Investigation, and Resolution*, 1 November 2011

USSOCOM Directive 71-4, *Special Operations Forces Capabilities Integration and Development System*, 22 January 2020

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

AF Form 1067, *Modification Proposal*

AF Form 4326, *Tactics Improvement Proposal*

AF Form 4327A, *Crew Flight (FA) Authorization*

AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

AFSOC Form 97, *Aircraft Incident Worksheet*

DD Form 1748-2, *Airdrop Malfunction Report (Personnel-Cargo)*

DD Form 365-4, *Weight and Balance Clearance Form F*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AAGS—Army Air-Ground System

ACC—Air Combat Command

ACO—Airspace Coordination Order

AD/AFRC—Active Duty/Air Force Reserve Command

AD/ANG—Active Duty/Air National Guard

AD—Active Duty

ADRP—Aerial Delivery Review Panel

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFMAN—Air Force Manual

AFMD—Air Force Mission Directive

AFPAM—Air Force Pamphlet

AFPC—Air Force Personnel Center

AFRC—Air Force Reserve Command

AFSC—Air Force Specialty Code

AFSOB—Air Force Special Operations Base

AFSOC—Air Force Special Operations Command

AFSOCI—Air Force Special Operations Command Instruction

AFSOCMAN—Air Force Special Operations Command Manual

AFSOF—Air Force Special Operations Forces

AFTTP—Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

AGI—Air-to-Ground Integration

AIC—Advanced Instructor Course

AMC—Air Mobility Command

AMSARB—Airdrop Malfunction and Safety Analysis Review Board

ANG—Air National Guard

AO—Area of Operation

AOB—Air Order of Battle

AOC—Air Operations Center

AOD—Air Operations Directive

AOR—Area of Responsibility

ARC—Air Reserve Component

ARMS—Aviation Resource Management System

ATIMS—AFSOC Tactics Information Management System

ATO—Air Tasking Order

ATR—Advanced Tactical Readiness

AUPM—Aviation Unit Preparation Message

AvFID—Aviation Foreign Internal Defense

AWACS—Airborne Warning and Control System

AZ—Assault Zone

C2—Command and Control

CAA—Combat Aviation Advisor

CCB—Configuration Control Board

CCT—Combat Control Team

CDS—Container Delivery System

CEP—Combat Entry Point

CERTEX—Certification Exercise

CFACC—Combined Forces Air Component Commander

CMNS—Combat Mission Needs Statement

CMP—Combat Mission Profile

CMR—Combat Mission Ready

CMS—Combat Mission Sortie

CMT—Combat Mission Training

COMSEC—Communications Security

CONEMP—Concept of Employment

CONOP—Concept of Operations

CONPLAN—Contingency Plan

CRO—Combat Rescue Officer

CSAR—Combat Search and Rescue

CSG—Configuration Steering Group

CSO—Combat Systems Officer

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DAFMAN – Department of the Air Force Manual

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DAN/TAN—Detection Avoidance Navigation/Threat Avoidance Navigation

DEAD—Destruction of Enemy Air Defenses

DFA—Detection Free Altitude

DOC—Designed Operational Capability

DoD—Department of Defense

DZ—Drop Zone

EA—Electronic Attack

EC—Electronic Combat

ECMO—Electromagnetic Counter Measures Officer

ECO—Electromagnetic Combat Officer

ECP—Electromagnetic Combat Pilot

ECSF—Electronic Combat Support Flight

EEI—Essential Elements of Information

EIS—Enterprise Information System

EMCON—Emission Control

EMSO—Electromagnetic Spectrum Operations

EOB—Electronic Order of Battle

EO—Electro-Optical

ETL—Engineering Technical Letter

EW—Electromagnetic Warfare

EWIR—Electronic Warfare Integrated Reprogramming

EWO—Electronic Warfare Officer

FAA—Functional Area Analysis or Federal Aviation Authority

FAAO—Federal Aviation Administration Order

FARP—Forward Area Refueling Point

FCO—Fire Control Officer

FDE—Force Development Evaluation

FID—Foreign Internal Defense

FLOT—Forward Line of Own Troops

FM—Functional Manager or Field Manual

FNA—Functional Needs Analysis

FORGEN—Force Generation

FSA—Functional Solution Analysis

GATER II/III—Global Air Tactics Employment Review II/III

GMAT—Ground Munitions Allocation Tables

GOB—Ground Order of Battle

HLZ—Helicopter Landing Zone

HQ—Headquarters

IADS—Integrated Air Defense System

IA—Initial Assessment

IAW—In Accordance With

ICD—Initial Capabilities Document

IFF—Identification, Friend or Foe

IO—Information Operation

IOS—Information Operations Squadron

IPT—Integrated Product Team

IR—Infrared

IST—Integrated Skills Training

I-TAAR—Immediate Tactics After Action Report

ITO—Integrated Tasking Order

IW—Irregular Warfare

IWO—Intelligence Weapons Officer

JAI—Joint Airdrop Inspection

JA—Judge Advocate

JCET—Joint Combined Exchange Training

JFACC—Joint Forces Air Component Commander

JFIRE—Joint Fires

JLLIS—Joint Lessons Learned Information System

JP—Joint Publication

JSOAC—Joint Special Operations Air Component

JSOTF—Joint Special Operations Task Force

JTAC—Joint Terminal Attack Controller

LL—Lessons Learned

LLWG—Lessons Learned Working Group

LM—Loadmaster

LZ—Landing Zone

MAF—Mobility Air Forces

MAJCOM—Major Command

MATT—Multi-Mode Advanced Tactical Terminal

MDRB—Munitions Delivery Review Board

MDS—Mission Design Series

METL—Mission Essential Task List

MICON—Mission Concept

MICT—Management Internal Control Toolset

MM—Model Manager

MR—Mission Ready

MST—Mission Support Team

MWS—Major Weapon System

NCO—Noncommissioned Officer

NGB—National Guard Bureau

NIPR—Non-classified Internet Protocol Router

NLT—No Later Than

NOB—Naval Order of Battle

NsAV—Non-standard Aviation

OCR—Operational Change Request / Office of Coordinating Responsibility

OPCON—Operational Control

OPLAN—Operations Plan

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

OPSEC—Operational Security

OSS—Operations Support Squadron

OT&E—Operational Test and Evaluation

PJ—Pararescueman

RTM—Ready Aircrew Tasking Memo

RW ACE—Real World Air Combat Environment

RWR—Radar Warning Receiver

SAMS-ESA—SOF Air Mission Suite-Enhanced Situational Awareness

SAM—Surface-to-Air Missile

SAP—Special Access Program

SAV—Staff Assistance Visit

SCI—Sensitive Compartmented Information

SEAD—Suppression of Enemy Air Defenses

SE—Safety

SINCGARS—Single Channel Ground and Airborne Radio System

SIPR—Secure Internet Protocol Router

SM—Single Manager

SNCO—Senior Noncommissioned Officer

SOCOM—Special Operations Command

SOF—Special Operations Forces

SOFTASE—Special Operations Forces Tactics and Adversaries Studies Element

SOFTAT—Special Operations Forces Tactics Analysis Team

SOLE—Special Operations Liaison Element

SOS—Special Operations Squadron

SOTES—Special Operations Test and Evaluation Squadron

SOTG—Special Operations Task Group

SOTU—Special Operations Task Unit

SPD—System Program Director

SPINS—Special Instructions

SPP—Strategic Planning Process

SQB—Secret Question Bank

SR—Special Reconnaissance

SSBI—Single Scope Background Investigation

SS—Silent Shield

STO—Special Tactics Officer or Special Technical Operations

STS—Special Tactics Squadron

TAAR—Tactics After Action Report

TACS—Theater Air Control System

TAT—Tactics Analysis Team

TD&E—Tactics Development and Evaluation

TDIP—Tactics Development Improvement Program

TFI—Total Force Integration

TIFP—Tactics Intra-fly Program

TIP—Tactics Improvement Proposal

TMT—Tactics/Tactician Management Training

TOA—Time of Arrival

TOT—Time on Target

TP—Threat Penetration

TRB—Tactics Review Board

TSOC—Theater Special Operations Command

TSO—Tactical System Operator

TSRTS—Threat System Recognition Training Software

TS—Top Secret

TTP—Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TWG—Tactics Working Group

UCI—Unit Compliance Inspection

UON—Urgent Operational Need

USAF—United States Air Force

USAFWS—United States Air Force Weapons School

USSF—United States Space Force

USSOCOM D—United States Special Operations Command Directive

USSOCOM—United States Special Operations Command

UTC—Unit Type Code

VALEX—Validation Exercise

VPE—Verification Planning Exercise

VRB—Verification Review Board

VTRAT—Visual Threat Recognition and Avoidance Trainer

WIC—Weapons Instructor Course

WPS—Weapons Squadron

WSIPT—Weapon System Integrated Product Team

WSO—Weapons Systems Officer

WS—Weapons School

Office Symbols

AF/A5RW—HQ Air Force Weapons Requirements Division

AFSOC/A1—HQ AFSOC Personnel Directorate

AFSOC/A2—HQ AFSOC Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance Directorate

AFSOC/A3/9—HQ AFSOC Operations Directorate

AFSOC/A3F—HQ AFSOC Concepts & Capabilities Division

AFSOC/A3FW—HQ AFSOC Weapons & Tactics Branch

AFSOC/A3TO—HQ AFSOC Functional Manager Branch

AFSOC/A4—HQ AFSOC Logistics, Engineering, and Force Protection Directorate

AFSOC/A4M—HQ AFSOC Maintenance Division

AFSOC/A4MX—HQ AFSOC Programs & Analysis Branch

AFSOC/A5/8—HQ AFSOC Strategic Plans & Programs

AFSOC/A5KR—HQ AFSOC Requirements Branch

AFSOC/A9L—HQ AFSOC Lessons Learned Office

SOCOM/J4—USSOCOM Logistics Office

Attachment 2

APPOINTMENT LETTER

Figure A2.1. Appointment Letter Example.

(Submitting Unit Leadership)

Date

MEMORANDUM FOR AFSOC/A3FW

FROM: XX SOS/DO

SUBJECT: Appointment of XXSOS Squadron/Group Tacticians

1. The following individual/s have been appointed as squadron/group tacticians and have met the minimum requirements outlined in AFSOCMAN 11-207. The are qualified instructors, maintaining a combat mission readiness status and have completed AFSOC Tactics Management Training.

Name	Rank	AFSC	Security Clearance	TMT Training Date

2. Please refer any questions to our weapons and tactics office at XXX-XXXX.

//Signed//

Squadron Operations Officer

Attachment 3

VPE PLANNING ELEMENTS

A3.1. General. In the absence of MDS-specific Volume 1 guidance, this attachment lists essential elements for accomplishing VPEs. This matrix is not intended as a format for briefing or debriefing.

A3.2. Introduction and Overview.

A3.2.1. Introduction (participants and briefing classification).

A3.2.2. Mission overview (mission intelligence, political scenarios, mission tasking, and JA issues).

A3.2.3. Status of friendly forces (ground, air, and support).

A3.3. Area of Operations.

A3.3.1. Geography (topography, population centers, lines of communication, chokepoints and natural obstacles, major visual and radar significant identification points).

A3.3.2. Climatology (effects on unit operations, ground troop movements, and in-flight operations).

A3.3.3. Operating base (location, facilities, procedural constraints, strengths, and limitations).

A3.3.4. ATO/ITO/ACO.

A3.4. Situation/Status of Enemy Forces.

A3.4.1. Ground forces and accompanying air defense threats (SAMs, Anti-Aircraft Artillery, EC, and Spectrum Interference Resolution reporting), capabilities, strengths, and weaknesses.

A3.4.2. Airborne forces (numbers, locations, capabilities, and tactics). RESCORT, RESCAP, AWACS, Reconnaissance, SEAD, EC-130, and Space.

A3.4.3. Discuss and decide on suppression, tactics, possible customer requirements, and other mission assumptions. Analyze both the country/area threat and threat emitter databases to anticipate the RF and IR environments the aircrews will encounter.

A3.5. Mission Employment.

A3.5.1. Communications plan.

A3.5.2. Ground operations (launch authority and method, weapons and ammo load, electronic countermeasures settings/load/type, special mission equipment).

A3.5.3. Departure (weather contingencies, options).

A3.5.4. Route of flight (threat analysis, alternatives, fuel requirements, decision points and charts, FENCE crossing authority).

A3.5.5. Target ingress (initial point-to-target specifics, execute authority, tactics, and contingencies).

A3.5.6. Weapons employment (target data, load, suitability, ROEs, and mutual support plans).

A3.5.7. Egress plan (route, mutual support agreements).

A3.5.8. Downed aircrew, wounded bird plan.

A3.5.9. Recovery (safe corridor procedures, Identification Friend or Foe (IFF) procedures, alternate and emergency airfields).

A3.5.10. Escape and Evasion (selected areas for recovery, CSAR procedures).

A3.6. Services and support.

A3.6.1. Supply (POL, FARP, expendables).

A3.6.2. Medical Facilities, Unit Care, Preventative Medicine, CBRN Considerations, SOF Casualty Movement, Medical Intelligence, Medical Planning (HN, Joint, PN PACE Plan), Medical Logistics, Medical Risk Mitigation.

A3.6.3. Maintenance (location, capabilities).

A3.6.4. Divert airfields.

A3.6.5. NBC equipment and decontamination.

A3.7. Command and Signal.

A3.7.1. Required COMSEC fills (e.g., wide/narrow band keys).

A3.7.2. Words, numbers, letters of the day.

A3.7.3. Execution checklist.

A3.7.4. Essential Elements of Information (EEIs).

A3.7.5. Required reports and reporting procedures.

Attachment 4

CMS OBSERVATION CHECKLIST

A4.1. CMS Observation Checklist. The following CMS observation checklists (**Tables A4.1 and A4.2**) provide examples for unit tacticians to observe aircrew, identify deficiencies, and initiate improvements. These checklists provide a sample that the unit tactician may modify and use when conducting a CMS mission as defined in this manual.

Table A4.1. CMS Observation Checklist (Pre-mission Planning Phase).

PREMISSION PLANNING PHASE	Complete
- Coordinate with squadron tactics office and the aircraft commander for authorization to be placed on flight orders. Ensure sufficient time for the operations admin to process flight orders.	
- At least one week prior to the mission, coordinate with scheduling to schedule the crew, tactician, mission, and required support (e.g., intel, wx, space, JA, refueling, jumpers) and facilities (e.g., ranges, DZs, LZs, HLZs).	
- Request a Silent Shield Operator to be scheduled for the flight.	
- Coordinate with supporting offices to ensure the information they provide to the crew is part of the scenario.	
- With sufficient time to allow for adequate pre-mission planning (usually 72 hours prior to mission execution), the tactics observer will provide threats applicable to the combat scenario. - Include 18 SOTES test report data on and or AFTTP 3-1.Threat Guide and AFTTP 3-1/3-3.MDS tactical information as required. - The scenario will include the following items: • Political/Military situation. • Objective (airdrop, infil/exfil, AR, or Helo AR) location. • Orders of battle (air, land, electronic, etc.) (.thr file overlay and .lcl points indicating location(s) of friendly/enemy forces/equipment).	

Table A4.2. CMS Observation Checklist (Mission Planning Phase).

MISSION PLANNING PHASE	Yes	No
1. Did all crew members attend and make effective use of the presenters at the mission in-brief?		
2. Were all crew members effectively employed in mission planning?		
3. Were requests for information and for support assets (e.g., SEAD, DEAD, AWACS, RJ) generated and provided to intel?		
4. Was appropriate coordination conducted with the customer and supporting assets to produce the best plan?		
5. Were the tactical employment events (airdrop, airland, AR) thoroughly planned and discussed to ensure all applicable crew members knows their responsibilities?		
6. Were detection avoidance techniques considered, utilized, and appropriate?		
7. Were appropriate threat avoidance/suppression techniques considered and utilized?		
8. Were appropriate threat evasion techniques considered and utilized?		
9. Were appropriate countermeasures for known threats reviewed and discussed?		
10. Was the evasion plan of action complete and understood by all crew members and customers (as necessary)?		
11. Was a “what if” session conducted to gain consensus on the best course of action for the most likely “unplanned” events?		
12. Was the crew proficient in using approved mission planning software for planning the flight and avoiding threats?		
13. Were mission planning tools utilized effectively?		
14. Was the crew proficient in using applicable AFTTP 3-1 volumes?		
15. Were chart markings and annotations correct?		

Attachment 5

AFSOC REPORTING PROCEDURES FOR WEAPON EMPLOYMENT INCIDENTS

Table A5.1. Aircraft Munitions Employment Investigation Required Information.

1. DATE/TIME
2. UNIT/S INVOLVED (FLYING, SUPPORTING, TACP/JTAC, RCO etc.)
3. NAME AND LOCATION OF RANGE
4. TYPE OF AIRCRAFT INVOLVED
5. TYPE OF MUNITION, CHAFF, OR FLARES
6. LIVE OR INERT ROUNDS
7. WEATHER (WINDS, CEILING, VISIBILITY, etc.)
8. INJURIES (KNOWN OR SUSPECTED)
9. COLLATERAL DAMAGE (KNOWN OR SUSPECTED)
10. HEADING AND ALTITUDE
11. SCORES FROM SURVEYED TARGETS FOR ALL WEAPON EMPLOYMENTS ACCOMPLISHED (TRAINING ONLY)
12. RANGE AND BEARING OR CLOCK POSITION AND DISTANCE FROM KNOWN
13. POINT ON THE RANGE (TRAINING ONLY)
14. RANGE AND BEARING OR CLOCK POSITION FROM INTENDED IMPACT POINT
15. SUSPECTED CAUSE OF OFF-RANGE IMPACT (TRAINING ONLY)
16. TGP/FLIR/LAR INFORMATION (PREFLIGHT/RECALCULATION/ACCEPTABLE LAUNCH AREA)
17. CURRENT IMPACT ZONE SURVEY/SAFETY OF FLIGHT REVIEW (TRAINING ONLY)
18. NARRATIVE OF EVENT SEQUENCE PREPARED BY EACH AIRCREW MEMBER
19. DD FORM 365-4, *WEIGHT AND BALANCE CLEARANCE FORM F*
20. AFSOC FORM 97, *AIRCRAFT INCIDENT WORKSHEET*
21. AF FORM 4327A, *CREW FLIGHT (FA) AUTHORIZATION*
22. ANY REMAINING ORDNANCE ON THE AIRCRFT